

Ohio Regulatory Reference

Ohio Regulatory Reference — Minimum Financial Responsibility and Claims Handling Timelines

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Purpose: Internal reference summarizing Ohio minimum auto liability limits and claims-handling timelines relevant to Meridian Mutual's Personal Auto line.

Effective: January 1, 2025

This document is a synthetic reference prepared for a software assessment corpus. Figures are presented for realism and internal consistency with this corpus only and should not be relied on as current legal advice or as an authoritative restatement of Ohio law.

1. Minimum Financial Responsibility Limits

Under Ohio's financial responsibility law, a motor vehicle owner or operator must maintain liability insurance no less than the following limits:

- Bodily injury liability: **\$25,000 per person / \$50,000 per accident**
- Property damage liability: **\$25,000 per accident**

All Meridian Mutual Personal Auto policies in this corpus carry Liability limits at or above these minimums; see each policyholder's Declarations page for the specific limits selected.

2. Claims-Handling Timelines Referenced by This Corpus

The following timelines inform the claim-acknowledgment provisions in Meridian Mutual's Policy Wording (Part G):

Requirement	Reference Timeline
Acknowledge receipt of a claim	10 business days
Begin an investigation after acknowledgment	15 business days
Communicate a coverage decision after investigation is complete	30 calendar days
Pay an undisputed claim after a	10 business days

coverage decision	
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Policy Form PAP-2025-STD aligns its claim-acknowledgment provision (Section 8.1) to the 10-business-day reference timeline above. Policy Form PAP-2024-STD predates this alignment and specifies 15 business days instead — both are valid depending on which form version governs a given policy period.

3. Required Disclosures

Ohio requires insurers to provide policyholders with a written explanation of any claim denial, including the specific policy provision relied upon. This corpus's Claims Adjudication Guidelines (Section 5) require every adjudication record to retain the specific policy and exclusion sections cited, which satisfies this requirement structurally.

4. Uninsured Motorist Coverage Offer Requirement

Ohio insurers are not required to include Uninsured/Underinsured Motorist Coverage automatically in every policy, but must offer it. All five sample policyholders in this corpus have elected UM/UIM coverage; see each Declarations page for the specific limits.